HEALTHCARE INTELLIGENCE · FROM PUBLIC SOURCES NO. 6

VIGILLINE DAILY

SATURDAY, 31 OCTOBER 2026 BENGALURU COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

FDA approves daraxonrasib (Rasonque), first in-class RAS-targeted therapy for metastatic pancreatic cancer

The US regulator approved Rasonque (daraxonrasib) on 26 August 2026 for adults with metastatic pancreatic adenocarcinoma after prior treatment. Median overall survival was 13.2 months with the drug and 6.7 months with standard chemotherapy, with a hazard ratio for death of 0.40.

The US Food and Drug Administration approved Rasonque (daraxonrasib) on 26 August 2026 for adults with metastatic pancreatic adenocarcinoma who have received at least one prior systemic therapy or who are not candidates for multiagent systemic therapy. It is the first approval of a medicine from a new class of RAS(ON) multi-selective and mutant-selective inhibitors, which target multiple forms of the RAS protein, a key driver of tumour growth in most patients with pancreatic adenocarcinoma.

The approval is based on RASolute 302 (NCT06625320), a randomised, open-label, multicentre phase 3 trial of 500 adults with previously treated metastatic pancreatic adenocarcinoma and disease progression after one prior line of systemic therapy. In the overall population, median overall survival was 13.2 months (95% CI 10.0, not estimable) with Rasonque and 6.7 months (95% CI 5.8, 8.0) with investigator's choice of cytotoxic chemotherapy; the hazard ratio for death was 0.40 (95% CI 0.30, 0.53; p<0.0001). The trial also showed statistically significant and clinically meaningful improvements in progression-free survival, objective response rate and patient-reported outcomes.

Rasonque is a 300 mg tablet taken once daily and is now available in the US. The FDA granted Breakthrough Therapy and Orphan Drug designations, reviewed the application under Priority Review and the Commissioner's National Priority Voucher pilot programme, and made the approval effective on the date of its letter. Approval covers tumours with or without an identified RAS mutation and does not require a companion diagnostic test.

For competitive intelligence, the approved population is narrow but consequential: metastatic pancreatic adenocarcinoma after prior therapy, where options are limited. The company is advancing daraxonrasib in a global phase 3 programme in pancreatic cancer and metastatic RAS-mutant non-small cell lung cancer, where it remains investigational.

IN NUMBERS

13.2 months
median overall survival with Rasonque in RASolute 302

6.7 months
median overall survival with standard chemotherapy in RASolute 302

0.40
hazard ratio for death with Rasonque versus standard chemotherapy

ALSO TODAY

Readout LOUD: Assessing Merck and Moderna's mRNA cancer vaccine
STAT NEWS

Hikal's Bengaluru API facility receives Swissmedic GMP certification
EXPRESS PHARMA

Sanofi may seek higher European drug prices, not withhold launches, under Trump deal
ENDPOINTS NEWS

BRIEFS

Vertex's kidney disease drug under infection-risk scrutiny before Nov 30 FDA decision

Vertex's kidney disease drug is under scrutiny for infection risk ahead of the FDA's approval decision on Nov 30, STAT News reported. The summary names no drug and gives no figures on the risk, its comparator or the regulator's view.

STAT NEWS

FDA approves Jemperli for rectal cancer patients who may avoid chemo and radiation

Dostarlimab (Jemperli) gained accelerated approval from the FDA on Oct 19 for Stage II or III locally advanced rectal cancer MSI-H or dMMR, a biomarker in about 3% of such tumours. In AZUR-1, 68% of 144 patients had no signs of cancer at 12 months, and nearly three-quarters avoided surgery, radiation and chemotherapy after more than two years of follow-up.

US FDA

Gilead pauses CAR-T after ICANS cases; Agios PDUFA date pushed back

Gilead paused its CAR-T programme after several cases of the neurological condition ICANS, Endpoints News reported. It also said Agios's PDUFA date has been pushed back, without giving a new date.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

AstraZeneca restructuring may mean R&D cuts and trials shifted to emerging markets

AstraZeneca's restructuring may mean R&D cuts and trials shifted to emerging markets, Endpoints News reported. The company is losing patent protection for Farxiga, the summary says, without a date for the loss.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

Pfizer rerouting supply after flooding sidelined its India injectables plant

Pfizer is looking to reroute supply after flooding sidelined its India injectables plant, Fierce Pharma reported. The Ahmedabad joint venture manufactures injectable chemotherapy drugs for US cancer patients; the summary gives no volumes, products or revenue at risk.

FIERCE PHARMA

Dren Bio raises $350 million to take its lead blood cancer drug to market by 2027

Dren Bio has raised $350 million, hoping to get its lead blood cancer drug onto the market by the end of 2027, Endpoints News reported. The summary gives no detail on the drug, its stage or the trial plan.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

SOURCES

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